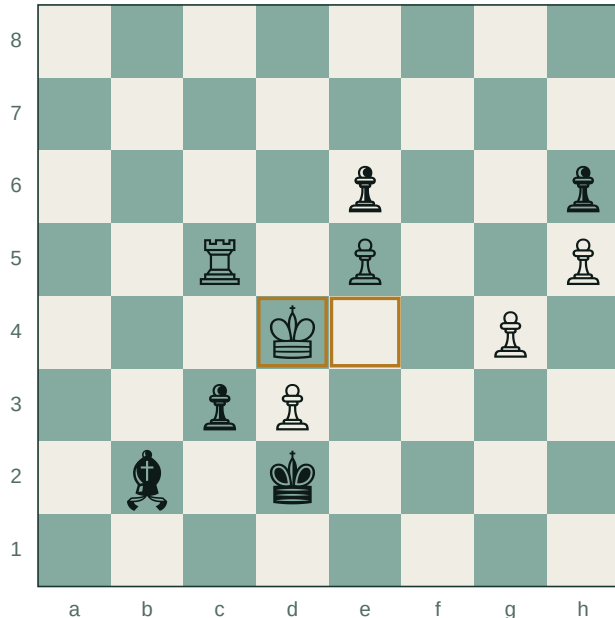


# Discovered checks: Black, move 58

Discovered checks

Black to move



Previous move: 58.Kxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**58...c2+ 59. Ke4 Bc3 60. Rc6 c1=Q**

**58...c2+** Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The changed line means the bishop on b2 attacks the king on d4. Recorded reply: **59.Ke4**.

**59...Bc3** The bishop moves from b2 to c3. Recorded reply: **60.Rc6**.

**60...c1=Q** The pawn moves from c2 to c1. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -3 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on d4. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.